

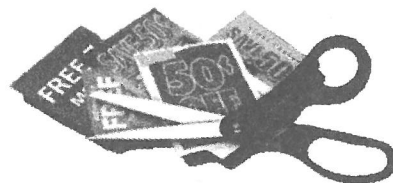
ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

Below is a blog entry about couponing:

Couponing – Job, Hobby, or Necessity?

Using coupons has become very popular these days. There are hundreds of websites and blogs available on the web for people to visit to help them learn how to use coupons effectively, share deals, get advice and exchange information on tips and deals.



When I am asked “doesn’t couponing seem like a full time job to you?”, my response is “It is my job to save my family money on groceries and other things.” When I first started couponing I spent a fair amount of time each week cutting, organizing, researching deals, etc. but it was not long before I got the hang of it and had a system! Now a couple of hours a week accomplishes my money saving goals!

I actually feel couponing is a hobby more than a job because hobbies are something people do because they enjoy it. I enjoy using coupons! It is exciting to see how much you saved at the end of a shopping trip just as a person would be excited seeing a completed hobby project!

When I started couponing I was a single mother of four young children and had just lost my job. It was not a hobby to start cutting costs, it was an absolute necessity. Although I am no longer a single mother, saving money is still a necessity. The fact is, no matter what your financial situation is, coupons can help save money to let you achieve your goals!

Your group is discussing the culture of using coupons. You may want to talk about:

- the types of coupons students normally use
- the reasons why people like to use coupons
- any potential disadvantages of couponing
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Do you use coupons?
2. Where can you get coupons from?
3. What other ways can you save money apart from using coupons?
4. Do you think couponing is a good hobby?
5. Would you be willing to spend your time on couponing?
6. Do you think coupons help make a company more popular?
7. Do you think some people could become addicted to couponing?
8. Does the culture of couponing affect people’s shopping behaviour?